

Nishant Dougall

Naarm, VIC • 0412 202 666 • nishantdougall@gmail.com

Community Services | Harm Reduction | Peer Support

- Empathetic community services professional with 4+ years' experience, leveraging a 9-year background in financial project management.
- Harm reduction advocate with lived experience as both a peer support recipient and provider, and extensive knowledge of service systems.
- Qualified with a Master's degree, Bachelor's degree, Diploma of Community Services, and SMART Recovery facilitator certification.
- Brings significant lived experience and insight into intersectional discrimination as a queer, non-binary, neurodivergent person of color.
- Excels in delivering compassionate, respectful, person-led, and non-judgmental support.
- Purposefully transitioned from the corporate sector, driven by a commitment to social justice and a goal of contributing to systemic change to end the war on drugs.

EDUCATION

Diploma of Community Services • Melbourne Polytechnic	Naarm
Master of Finance • Monash University	Naarm
Bachelor of Business in Marketing • Qld University of Technology	Meanjin

SKILLS

Peer Support & Harm Reduction	Community Services	Transferable Skills
• AOD services and supports • Lapse and Relapse Prevention Strategies • Lived Experience Advocacy • Non-Judgmental Support • Pharmacokinetics Knowledge • Poly-substance Use Guidance • SMART Recovery Facilitation	• Cultural Awareness, Humility, Sensitivity. • Health Promotion • Informed Consent Protocols • Person-led, Strengths-based Support. • Systems Advocacy • Trauma-Informed Care	• Adaptability in dynamic environments. • Co-design Facilitation • Data Entry and Management • Process Improvement • Project Delivery • Stakeholder, Multi-disciplinary Collaboration

WORK EXPERIENCE

headspace	Apr 2024 – Nov 2024
Multicultural Practice Team Intern	Naarm, VIC
• Spearheaded a multicultural project by leading co-design focus groups with 36 international students, resulting in the creation of culturally sensitive mental health resources approved for national rollout. • Designed and developed diversity and inclusion web content based on headspace ethos and methodology, considered best practice.	

**Diamond Valley Community Support
Community Support Worker**

**Mar 2022 – Mar 2024
Naarm, Australia**

- Provided comprehensive service delivery to individuals in crisis, including emergency relief, material aid, and advocacy, with a focus on person-centred and strengths-based practice.
- Conducted over 400 client interviews to assess needs, develop tailored support plans, and advocacy for individuals facing complex challenges, including those impacted by criminalization.
- Delivered empathetic and compassionate support, utilizing de-escalation techniques to ensure client well-being.

**Thorne Harbour Health
Emergency Relief Delivery Volunteer**

**Dec 2018 – Sep 2020
Naarm**

- Delivered over 1000 food packages to isolated clients as part of the Rainbow Connection program, assisting with provision of food and access to essential services and emotional support.

Harm Reduction Peer Worker

Naarm, VIC

- Leveraged lived experience to lead bi-weekly peer support groups, cultivating a safe, non-judgmental environment that empowered clients with harm reduction strategies and relapse prevention skills.
- Integrated a sound understanding of drug effects and pharmacokinetics to provide tailored, peer-to-peer coaching on poly-substance use and medication interactions.

Sexual Health Outreach Support Worker

Naarm

- Provided support to over 100 clients at sex-on-premises venues, answering questions about sexual and mental health.
- Provided appropriate information and resources, embodying respectful service delivery and leveraging a strong peer-based approach informed by personal experience and awareness of emerging AOD trends.

**Coutts & Co
Project Manager**

**Feb 2018 – Sep 2018
London, UK**

- Managed multiple concurrent projects to successful completion, ensuring the private banking division of Royal Bank of Scotland complied with new government-mandated consumer protection regulations.

**Royal Bank of Scotland (RBS)
Project Manager**

**Jan 2016 – Sep 2018
London, UK**

- Led the RBS Corporate Banking workstream of an ethics project centered on a portfolio of high-net-value clients representing over £200M in assets, mitigating reputational risk from aggressive tax avoidance strategies

**Independent Television News (ITN)
Business Analyst**

**Feb 2014 – Mar 2015
London, UK**

**National Australia Bank (NAB)
Project Analyst
Graduate Program**

**Jan 2009 – Dec 2010
Naarm, VIC
Naarm, Victoria**

CERTIFICATIONS

Alcohol and Other Drug Skill Set (IN PROGRESS)

Odyssey Institute

SMART Recovery Peer Facilitator

SMART Recovery Australia

Mental Health First Aid

Working With Children Check